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Taking Bearings — AI and Open Knowledge Production

A knowledge garden mapping the landscape where artificial intelligence meets open scholarship, knowledge production, and social implications — built from 180 research sources and structured for exploration.



What Is This?

This is a **knowledge garden** — an interconnected web of notes, concepts, and annotations drawn from the research scan AI and Open Knowledge Production. Unlike a traditional paper or report, this garden is designed to be **explored non-linearly**: follow links, browse by theme, or trace connections across the network.

Who is it for? Researchers, practitioners, policymakers, and anyone interested in how AI is reshaping open scholarship and knowledge production.

What does it contain?

What	Count	Description
 Annotations	180	Summarized research sources with metadata and cross-references
 Concept Hubs	55	Key ideas linking related annotations together
 Tensions	4	Cross-cutting debates that run through the literature
 Domains	4	Major thematic areas organizing the research
 Cross-References	593	Curated connections between notes (top 3 per annotation)

Quick Start — How to Navigate

New here? Start with one of these paths:

If you want to...	Start here
 Read the full narrative overview	[[Analytical Introduction]]
 See the big picture of concepts	[[Conceptual Map]]
 Look up a specific concept	[[Concepts Glossary]]
 Browse all sources by topic	[[Index by Domain]]
 Explore key debates	Jump to [[#Four Cross-Cutting Tensions]] below

Navigation tips:

- Click any `[[link]]` to follow it to a connected note
- Use the **graph view** (if available) to visualize the network of connections
- Use **search** to find specific topics, authors, or concepts
- Use **backlinks** on any page to see what links to it
- **Browse by folder** using the explorer sidebar

Core Documents

Start here for the main narrative and findings:

- **[[Analytical Introduction]]** — The central analytical essay linking 93 citations across all four domains and tensions. This is the primary entry point for reading the research synthesis.
- **[[Recommendations]]** — Areas for institutional action drawn from the research
- **[[Complete Alphabetical List of References]]** — Full bibliography of all sources
- **[[Citation Index]]** — Reverse index showing which annotations appear in which sections

Explore by Structure

Navigate the garden through different lenses:

Browse & Discover

- **[[Conceptual Map]]** — Thematic overview of how concepts relate to each other
- **[[Concepts Glossary]]** — Comprehensive glossary with definitions and cross-references
- **[[Index by Domain]]** — Browse annotations by knowledge domain
- **[[Index by Subdomain]]** — Browse by specific topic area
- **[[Index by Tension]]** — See annotations grouped by the debates they engage
- **[[Index by Author]]** — Find annotations by author name
- **[[Index by Methodology]]** — Browse by research methodology

Four Domains

The research is organized into four major thematic areas:

Domain	Focus
[[Essential Contexts]]	Histories, theories, and foundations of AI
[[AI and Scholarship]]	AI's impact on scholarly research practices
[[AI and Social]]	Social implications, bias, labour, and critical perspectives
[[AI and Open]]	Intersection of AI with open knowledge movements

Four Cross-Cutting Tensions

These recurring debates cut across all four domains:

Tension	The Debate
[[Openness vs Enclosure]]	Open knowledge commons vs. proprietary AI control
[[Efficiency vs Process]]	Speed and scale of AI vs. careful, deliberate scholarship
[[Technical Capability vs Organizational Capacity]]	What AI can do vs. what institutions can support
[[Operational Assistance vs Epistemic Authority]]	AI as a productivity tool vs. AI as a knowledge authority



Concept Hubs

The garden contains **55 concept hub notes** that each gather all annotations discussing a particular idea — from epistemic authority to data sovereignty to algorithmic bias. Browse them in the **01-Concepts/** folder, or start from the **[[Concepts Glossary]]** for definitions.



About This Garden

This knowledge garden was generated from the research scan “Taking Bearings: AI and Open Knowledge Production” through NLP-enhanced content analysis and semantic linking. It is designed to be published with **Quartz** (<https://quartz.jzhao.xyz/>) as a static website and can also be explored locally in **Obsidian** (<https://obsidian.md/>).

Structure overview:

```
knowledge-garden/
├── 00-Maps/           → Navigation, introductions, and overview documents
├── 01-Concepts/       → 55 concept hub notes
├── 02-Tensions/       → 4 cross-cutting tension notes
├── 03-Domains/        → 4 domain overview notes
├── 04-Annotations/    → 180 individual research source annotations
├── 05-Indexes/        → Indexes by author, domain, tension, methodology
```

Knowledge garden created 2026-05-14 · [Source Document](https://github.com) (<https://github.com>) · Built for exploration